

IT IS TIME FOR RESURRECTION

INTRO: Today we are going to talk about resurrection in a historic sense (2,000 plus years ago) and what resurrection looks like in the 21st century.

Most Christians have the resurrection tucked away in a nice, neat, little historical package that they can reflect on once a year, and then move on to more pressing and significant issues.

It is my hope that when you walk out of this church today, you will never view resurrection in the same way! I pray that the lights will come on for all of us and that we will not only believe in the resurrection, but walk in its enormous power every day for the rest of our lives.

Luke 24:1-9 (NKJV) *“Now on the first day of the week, very early in the morning, they, and certain other women with them, came to the tomb bringing the spices which they had*

prepared. 2 But they found the stone rolled away from the tomb. 3 Then they went in and did not find the body of the Lord Jesus. 4 And it happened, as they were greatly perplexed about this, that behold, two men stood by them in shining garments. 5 Then, as they were afraid and bowed their faces to the earth, they said to them, “Why do you seek the living among the dead? 6 He is not here, but is risen! Remember how He spoke to you when He was still in Galilee, 7 saying, ‘The Son of Man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, and be crucified, and the third day rise again.’” 8 And they remembered His words. 9 Then they returned from the tomb and told all these things to the eleven and to all the rest.”

RESURRECTION AS AN HISTORICAL FACT

Resurrection is:

- The most significant event in the history of the world... 1 Corinthians 15:17 (CEV)

“Unless Christ was raised to life, your faith is useless, and you are still living in your sins.”

- The most misunderstood topic in the current culture...
- The most meaningful word in the Christian vocabulary...

The resurrection of Christ from the dead is the most important event in the history of the world. This is true because the resurrection of Christ from the dead validates:

- His virgin birth...
- His sinless life...
- His brutal death...
- His claim to be the Messiah...

If Christ had not been raised from the dead, His death would have been nothing more than another (among many) brutal executions via crucifixion. The good news is that He did in fact rise from the dead on the third day!

RESURRECTION IN REAL TIME

According to the resurrection chapter, 1 Corinthians 15:

- Our faith is predicated on the resurrection... (Without the resurrection – “*Our faith is in vain*”)
- The resurrection is the bedrock of what we preach... (No resurrection – “*We are false witnesses*”)
- The forgiveness of sin is tied to the resurrection... (No resurrection – “*We are yet in our sin*”)
- The physical resurrection of the dead in Christ depends on the resurrection of Jesus... (No resurrection – “*The dead rise not*”)
- Our contentment and joy stems from the resurrection... (No resurrection – “*We are of all men most miserable*”)
- The resurrection furnishes the impetus for the final defeat of death as an enemy... (Because of the resurrection – “*The last enemy to be destroyed - death*”)

- The second coming of the Lord is guaranteed because His first coming ended in a resurrection... (Because of the resurrection – *“I show you a mystery”*)

CONCLUSION:

You may be able to bury Jesus in a compartment of your life but sooner or later He is going to resurrect, and you will have to deal with Him. You can banish Him from:

- Your lifestyle - He will eventually challenge how you are choosing to live...
- Your relationships – Sooner or later He will be the last one standing and you must answer for who He is...
- Your finances – In time, you will have to admit *“All good and perfect things come from above.”*
- Your home – You will discover He is the only real source of peace...
- Your eternity – *“Every knee shall bow...”*